



The Hour of His Judgment

Sabbath School Study Notes
Lesson 3

PHASE 4 SDA BRANCH

Revelation 14:7

THE FIRST ANGEL'S MESSAGE • LESSON 3 • REVELATION 14:7

The Hour of His Judgment

Revelation 14:7

What immediately runs through our minds when we think about the hour of His judgment? Better yet — what is judgment?

1 What Is Judgment?

There are multiple ways we can describe judgment:

1	Decision-making
2	Opinion
3	Legal system

All three apply to what Revelation 14:7 is speaking to. The hour of judgment involves a decision-making, opinion-based legal system. The end goal is to give a verdict — guilty or innocent.

In the modern judicial system, guilt requires evidence. The claims must be verified, the evidence weighed by a judge, and only then is a decision made.

2 A Biblical Case Study: Genesis 3

Genesis 3:1–2

The serpent asks the woman whether God had said that the fruit of the tree should not be eaten. Let us place a like-for-like comparison of what God said and what Eve said:

Genesis 2:16–17 — What God said	Genesis 3:2–3 — What Eve said
<i>"Of every tree of the garden you may freely eat; but of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil you shall not eat, for in the day that you eat of it you shall surely die."</i>	<i>"We may eat the fruit of the trees of the garden; but of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of the garden, God has said, You shall not eat it, nor shall you touch it, lest you die."</i>

Eve correctly recalls that every tree of the garden may be eaten — a reference to Genesis 2:16. And she is right that the tree in the midst of the garden should not be eaten of. But look at the closing words of Genesis 3:3:

"Neither shall ye touch it, lest ye die."

— Genesis 3:3 (KJV)

KEY OBSERVATION

Eve introduced something God never said — that the tree should not be touched. God's instruction was only not to eat of it. Eve added to the word of God.

3 The Fall and the Judgment

Genesis 3:6–9 (NKJV)

"So when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree desirable to make one wise, she took of its fruit and ate. She also gave to her husband with her, and he ate. Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they knew that they were naked; and they sewed fig leaves together and made themselves coverings. And they heard the sound of the Lord God walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and Adam and his wife hid themselves from the presence of the Lord God among the trees of the garden. Then the Lord God called to Adam and said to him, 'Where are you?'"

Was God coming to drive them out of the garden?

God was always in communion with Adam and Eve in the garden. As part of His routine, He would come down and walk with them. The Spirit of Prophecy records:

"Often they were visited by His messengers, the holy angels, and from them received counsel and instruction. Often as they walked in the garden in the cool of the day they heard the voice of God, and face to face held communion with the Eternal."

— Education, p. 21.1

Do our actions determine what the Lord's coming means for us?

If Adam and Eve had been obedient, He would not need to ask where they are. But sin creates separation. Isaiah 59:1–2 makes this plain:

Isaiah 59:1–2 (NKJV)

"Behold, the Lord's hand is not shortened, that it cannot save; nor His ear heavy, that it cannot hear. But your iniquities have separated you from your God; and your sins have hidden His face from you, so that He will not hear."

Through their actions, judgment was passed — and they were driven from the garden. Would judgment have occurred at all if they had not eaten of the tree?

? Revisiting Our Definition

Let us bring the three parts of our definition back to the garden:

Decision-making	What decision would God have made?
Opinion	Is it right or wrong?
Legal system	What is the output?

Next week we will build on what we have covered today.

**NEXT
WEEK**

For next week: What does judgment mean for you?